

Joy Lee-Shi

Educator and Researcher

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Profile

A Belizean-born educator and researcher with experience in experimental psychology (quantitative, qualitative, computational text-based) research, psychometrics, and tertiary-level teaching.

Education

Mas-	Simon Fraser University , Experimental Psychology (History, Quantitative, Theoret-	Burnaby, British Columbia,
ter of	ical Specialization)	Canada
Arts	• Thesis: Adversity and Trauma: Examining and Elaborating the Hybrid Model of Stress Response as Applied to Belizean Contexts • Supervisor: Dr. Robert G. Ley	Jan 2023 – Jan 2025
Bach-	Simon Fraser University , Psychology (Honours with Distinction)	Burnaby, British Columbia,
elor of	• Thesis: Differences in Flow State and Flow Disposition in Jazz vs. Classical Musi-	Canada
Arts	cians and their Practice • Supervisor: Dr. Robert G. Ley	Jan 2018 – Jan 2022
Asso-	St. John’s College Junior College , Pure Mathematics	Belize
ciate		Jan 2016 – Jan 2018
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Academic Positions

University of Belize , Lecturer (Sessional)	Belize
• Course: Research Methods	Fall 2026
St. John’s College - University , Psychology Lecturer (Sessional)	Belize
• Courses: Industrial and Organizational Psychology, Behavioral Genetics, Adolescent Development, Neuropsychology, Research in Psychology	Spring 2026
Simon Fraser University , Invited Guest Lecturer - PSYC 770 - Proseminar in Personality	Burnaby, British Columbia,
• Instructor: Dr. Robert G. Ley	Canada
• Lecture topic: The Big Five Personality Traits	Spring 2024
Simon Fraser University , Teaching Assistant and TA Mentor - PSYC 201W - Introduction to Research Methods in Psychology	Burnaby, British Columbia,
	Canada
	Spring 2025; Summer 2024
Simon Fraser University , Teaching Assistant - PSYC 201W - Introduction to Research Methods in Psychology	Burnaby, British Columbia,
	Canada
	Fall 2024; Spring 2024; Fall 2023

Research Experience

Freelance , Statistical Analyst	Belize
• Conduct analyses for PhD research on Child Protective Services (CPS) workers’ experiences with stress, burnout, and trauma.	July 2026 – present

Belize National Association of Social Workers (BNASW) , Co-Author and Statistical Analyst Lead the design, analysis, and report writing for a nationwide needs assessment survey.	Belize Sept 2025 – present
Indigenous Peoples Participation in Higher Education Project (IPinHE) - Belizean Branch , Co-Author and Statistical Analyst - Principal Investigator: Dr. Filiberto Penados - Conducted statistical analyses and produced a 77-page report.	Belize July 2025 – present
Dr. Robert G. Ley , Literature Review Assistant Conducted scoping reviews in support of forensic clinical psychological expert witness evaluations and reports.	Jan 2022 – Jan 2023
Simon Fraser University, Attention Lab , Research Assistant - Lab Director: Dr. Thomas Spalek - Led participant intake and debriefing for Evaluative Space Model and Flanker studies.	Burnaby, British Columbia, Canada Jan 2021 – Jan 2023
Simon Fraser University, Measurement and Modelling Lab , Research Assistant - Lab Director: Dr. Rachel T. Fouladi - Transcribed 40+ audio-recorded interviews (30-80 minutes each). - Supported three Master's students' projects through qualitative coding and thematic analysis using NVivo and Excel.	Burnaby, British Columbia, Canada Jan 2020 – Jan 2023
Independent Research , Researcher - Topic: Text-Based Big-Data Analyses on Discussions of Dissociation - Developed Python and R scripts to web-scrape and clean Reddit posts. - Used natural language processing methods to analyze text-based big data through topic modelling, term-frequency inverse document frequency, and latent Dirichlet allocation.	Jan 2022 – Jan 2023

Professional Service

St. John's College - University, Emerging Scholars Conference , Conference Organizer	Feb 2026 – Apr 2026
Itz'at STEAM Academy , Special Education Resource Teacher - Curated evidence-based materials for student accommodations. - Developed and delivered Student Inclusion & Learning to first- and second-year students across six classrooms using evidence-based frameworks.	Belize Aug 2025 – Dec 2025
Journal of Belizean Research , Peer Reviewer	Aug 2024 – present
Simon Fraser University, Undergraduate Journal of Psychology , Graduate Reviewer	Mar 2024 – Oct 2025
Simon Fraser University, Psychological Methods in Action: PSYC 201W Spring Conference , Conference Organizer	Jan 2025 – May 2025
Simon Fraser University, Psychology Graduate Caucus , Experimental Psychology Departmental Representative	July 2024 – Apr 2025

Clinical Experience

Belize City Lions Club , Program Co-Facilitator, Peer Advocacy & Leadership: Psychological First Aid Training for Youth Supervised and co-led a Psychological First Aid training workshop.	Belize Aug 2026
GOJoven Belize Alumni Association , Peer Navigator - Provided HIV testing and pre-/post-test counselling. - Delivered peer counselling to one client, including psychoeducation on stress responses and guidance in identifying coping strategies and sources of stress.	Belize May 2025 – Oct 2025

META Belize , Program Co-Facilitator, Strong Roots, Brave Voices - Co-led a trauma-focused cognitive behavioural therapy (TF-CBT) group adapted for Belizean adolescents in conflict with the law and experiencing grief and traumatic stress. - Facilitator: Azalia G. Larrieu, LCSW, MSW, CCTS-I	Belize July 2025 – Sept 2025
Metro Vancouver , Career Development Mentor in Behaviour Intervention Facilitated discussions on ethical practices, effective client (parent and child) engagement, and career challenges.	Canada Jan 2024 – Apr 2025
Metro Vancouver , Senior Behaviour Interventionist - Implemented one-on-one ABA intervention plans to foster adaptive behaviours, communication, social skills, and self-regulation in children aged 4-8 with ASD. - Recruited, supervised, and trained behaviour interventionists. - Supervisor: Zoe Liu, M.Ed., BCBA	Canada Oct 2023 – Nov 2024
Metro Vancouver , Behaviour Interventionist - Implemented individualized ABA- and ESDM-based behaviour interventions for children aged 3-12 with ASD and attention disorders. - Supervisors: Zoe Liu, Yvonne Kong, and Karla Suarez (M.Ed., BCBAs)	Canada Feb 2022 – Dec 2023

Clinical Experience for Research Purposes

Trauma, Coping and Post-traumatic Changes Study in Belize , Research Interviewer - Based on Grounded Theory and IPA principles, designed, conducted, and analyzed semi-structured interviews with 12 adults (1-3 hours each) on adversity/trauma, coping, and post-stressor changes. - Supervisor: Dr. Robert G. Ley	Belize Summer 2024
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Clinical Training

Stress and Trauma: An Attachment-Based Perspective Training by Gordon Neufeld, Ph.D., R. Psych.	Nov 2024
Trauma-informed Supports for Autism Presented by Alexia Stack and Ben Reiman (M.A., BCBAs).	Oct 2024
Indigenous Approaches to Trauma and Wellness Training by Karlee Fellner, Ph.D., R. Psych.	Feb 2024

Books & Book Chapters

- Young, L., & Lee-Shi, J. (2026). *Psychological first aid for young peers: A handbook*. Belize City Lions Club Mental Health Committee.
- Lee-Shi, J. (2024). In the zone: Understanding the mystique of flow. In D. Lacey & J. Lee-Shi (Eds.), *Beautiful Belize City* (pp. 36–37). Yaoling Lee.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- Young, L., & Lee-Shi, J. (in press). Boots on the ground, cracks in the system: BDF mental health and wellbeing. *Keeping Independence Alive: Belize @45*.
- Penados, F., Rosado, L., Tzib, D., Lee-Shi, J., & Gonzalez, G. N. (2026). Indigenous peoples participation in higher education in Belize: Present realities and its implications for policy and practice. *Ichan Tecolotl*, 400. <https://ichan.ciesas.edu.mx/indigenous-peoples-participation-in-higher-education-in-belize-present-realities-and-its-implication-for-policy-and-practice/>
- Lee-Shi, J., & Ley, R. G. (2022). A critique of the Dispositional Flow Scale-2 (DFS-2) and Flow State Scale-2 (FSS-2). *Frontiers in Psychology*, 13, Article 992813. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2022.992813>

Conferences & Symposiums

- Vairez, M., & Lee-Shi, J. (2026, September). *Grit, mental health, and pandemic related adversity among adolescents in Belize* [Conference presentation]. The Belize-Mexico Binational Seminar, Belize.
- Vairez, M., & Lee-Shi, J. (2026, September). *Validating the Short Grit Scale (Grit-S) with a sample of adolescents in Belize* [Conference presentation]. The Belize-Mexico Binational Seminar, Belize.
- Young, L., & Lee-Shi, J. (2026, September). *Boots on the ground, cracks in the system: BDF mental health and wellbeing* [Conference presentation]. Keeping Independence Alive: Belize @45, Belize Policy Research Institute (BEPRI), Belize.
- Penados, F., Rosado, L., Lee-Shi, J., Tzib, D., & Gonzalez, N. G. (2025, October). *Indigenous peoples' participation in higher education in Belize: Present realities and its implications for policy and practice* [Oral presentation]. Belize KULCHA Symposium, Heritage Education Network, Belize.
- Penados, F., Rosado, L., Lee-Shi, J., & Tzib, D. (2025, September). *Indigenous peoples in higher education: A diagnostic – Belize* [Oral presentation]. Second General Meeting, Ciencia y Tecnologia, International Development Research Centre, Costa Rica.
- Lee-Shi, J., & Ley, R. G. (2025, May). *From adversity to trauma: Examining and elaborating the Hybrid Model of Stress Response as applied to Belizean contexts* [Paper presentation, symposium]. Inaugural Conference on Critical Social Justice in Psychology, Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada.
- Lee-Shi, J., & Ley, R. G. (2025, April). *The double-edged sword of social support: Protective and risk factors in trauma recovery in Belize* [Oral presentation]. 22nd Hawai'i International Summit on Preventing, Assessing & Treating Trauma Across the Lifespan, Hawaii, USA.
- Lee-Shi, J., & Wong, M. (2024, May). *Cognitive emotion regulation in depression: Potential insights from natural language processing analyses* [Poster presentation]. Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies Annual Student Research Symposium, virtual conference.
- Lee-Shi, J., & Fouladi, R. T. (2024, April). *Defining resilience beyond trauma and violence in Belizean communities* [Poster presentation]. Justice, Reconciliation, Equity, Diversity, Accessibility, and Inclusion (JEDAI) Research Fair, Burnaby, British Columbia, Canada.
- Lee-Shi, J. (2024, March). *Exploring the psychology of gang involvement and its impact on the community* [Data blitz presentation]. 2024 Criminal Minds – An Interdisciplinary Conference, Burnaby, British Columbia, Canada.
- Lee-Shi, J., & Fouladi, R. T. (2023, May). *Manual text feature and machine-learning analyses on think-aloud concussion assessment transcriptions: Who finds what confusing?* [Poster presentation]. Connecting Minds Research Conference, Richmond, British Columbia, Canada.
- Lee-Shi, J., Ley, R. G., Cox, D., & Sugarman, J. (2022, June). *A pilot study: Differences in flow state and flow disposition in jazz vs. classical musicians and their practice* [Poster presentation]. Annual Canadian Psychological Association Convention, Calgary, Alberta, Canada.
- Lee-Shi, J., Ley, R. G., Cox, D., & Sugarman, J. (2022, March). *Differences in flow state and flow disposition in jazz vs. classical musicians and their practice* [Symposium presentation]. Simon Fraser University Undergraduate Research Symposium, Burnaby, British Columbia, Canada.

Other Presentations

- Penados, F., Rosado, L., Tzib, D., & Lee-Shi, J. (2026, June). *Indigenous participation in higher education: Key findings and recommendations* [Roundtable presentation]. Galen University, Belize.
- Penados, F., Rosado, L., Tzib, D., & Lee-Shi, J. (2025, October). *Advancing inclusive policies for Indigenous participation in higher education: Present realities and implications* [Oral presentation]. Indigenous Resistance Day Lecture and Workshop, University of Belize, Belmopan, Belize.
- Lee-Shi, J., Barrett, R., & Aldenhoven, L. M. (2024, July). *Gender minorities and crisis support in Vancouver: Perceptions and impacts* [Poster presentation]. Burnaby Pride Festival, Burnaby, British Columbia, Canada.

Awards

Selected Author

Jan 2025

The Annual Celebration of SFU Authors 2024, Simon Fraser University.

Graduate Fellowship Simon Fraser University. \$14,000 CAD.	2023 - 2024
Special Graduate Entrance Scholarship Simon Fraser University. \$5,000 CAD.	2023 - 2024
Honourable Mention Winner for Best Psychology Data Blitz Presentation Criminal Minds 2024 - An Interdisciplinary Conference, Simon Fraser University.	Jan 2024
President's Honour Roll Simon Fraser University.	2022, 2020
Dean's Honour Roll Simon Fraser University.	2022, 2020, 2019
Undergraduate Open Scholarship Simon Fraser University. \$990 CAD.	Jan 2021
Dean's Honour List St. John's College Junior College.	2016 - 2018
National 1st Place in Mathematics Association of Tertiary Level Institutions in Belize (ATLIB).	Jan 2016

Certificates

Teaching License, Level: Secondary [Education] - Counselling Belize Ministry of Education. Expires July 2027.	July 2025
Peer Navigator GOJoven Belize Alumni Association (GOBelize), for providing HIV Voluntary Counselling.	May 2025
TCPS 2: CORE (Tri-Council Policy Statement: Ethical Conduct for Research Involving Humans) Course on Research Ethics.	2024, 2020

Languages

Mandarin: Conversational
Spanish: Basic Conversational

Volunteer

Belize National Orchestra , Wind Section Mentor, Principal Flautist	Belize 2025 - Present; 2012 - 2016
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Professional Memberships

Mental Health Association, Belize , Board Member	Sept 2025 – present
American Psychological Association, Division 56 Trauma Psychology , Graduate Student Member	Jan 2024 – Jan 2025